

The Daily Brief

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AI & Tech News

Latest in artificial intelligence, models, and technology

SpaceX IPO Prices at \$135 Per Share, Marking the Largest IPO in History. SpaceX has officially priced its shares at \$135, making the semiconductor-infrastructure-to-space-exploration company the most valuable private company to ever go public. The offering is expected to raise tens of billions of dollars and values SpaceX at over \$250 billion. For context, that puts it ahead of every listed company in the S&P 500 except the largest handful of mega-caps. Existing investors in the secondary market had been trading shares at implied valuations above \$200 billion for months — so the \$135 price represents a premium to where the private market was, not a discount to it. Trading begins immediately, and the immediate pop question is whether it keeps climbing or whether the biggest IPO in history meets the biggest sell-the-news reaction in history. (TechCrunch)

Jeff Bezos's Prometheus Raises \$12 Billion to Build an "Artificial General Engineer." While the AI world has been focused on language models and software agents, Jeff Bezos has been quietly backing something more physical. Prometheus, his latest venture, announced a \$12 billion raise to develop what he is calling an "artificial general engineer" — an AI system capable of autonomously designing, building, and iterating on physical hardware. The vision is essentially AGI for the engineering of physical things: robots that can design better robots, factories that can redesign themselves. It is a bet that the next frontier of AI is not in servers but in lathes, carbon fiber, and materials science. Whether that vision is achievable is very much an open question — but the capital being deployed behind it is not small. (TechCrunch)

Theker Raises \$85 Million to Build the Factory Robot That Does Not Specialize in Anything. Manufacturing robots are usually built for one task — weld this panel, screw this bolt, paint this door. They are extraordinarily capable at their one thing and useless at anything else. Theker is building something different: a generalist factory robot that can be retasked by software rather than requiring physical retooling. The \$85 million Series A is a bet that the future of manufacturing flexibility is a robot that can learn new tasks the way a human would — by watching and doing — rather than being programmed for a single fixed workflow. If it works, it would be the most significant advance in manufacturing automation since industrial robotics itself. (TechCrunch)

Meta's Edits App Gets an AI Assistant and a Desktop Version. Meta is bringing its Edits video creation app to desktop and adding an AI-powered assistant that can suggest cuts, transitions, and even generate B-roll based on text prompts. The move is a direct shot across the bow of Adobe's Creative Suite and an acknowledgment that the Creator economy is shifting toward AI-assisted workflows. Meta has been unusually aggressive about bringing AI features across its app ecosystem — Edits, Ray-Ban smart glasses, and the core Facebook/Instagram AI tools — in what looks like a deliberate strategy to own the AI-enhanced content creation stack before Apple or Google can. (TechCrunch)

Oracle Warns of Security Bug That Hackers Exploited to Breach Over 100 Companies. Oracle issued a rare public warning this week about a critical security vulnerability in its cloud infrastructure that has already been exploited to breach more than 100 organizations. The bug allowed attackers to move laterally from Oracle's shared infrastructure into customer environments — a particularly uncomfortable scenario because Oracle's cloud is used by many enterprises for mission-critical workloads precisely because of its reputation for security. The disclosure is a reminder that the concentration of enterprise workloads in a handful of cloud providers creates systemic risk: one bug, one misconfiguration, one supply chain attack can cascade across hundreds of organizations simultaneously. (TechCrunch)

Financial & Market News

Stock markets, crypto, economic indicators, and investor positioning

S&P; 500 Closes Near Record Highs as Investors Brace for Inflation Data. The S&P; 500 has been grinding higher as traders await the next Consumer Price Index reading, with market positioning suggesting institutional investors remain broadly long equities despite elevated valuations. The index has not pulled back meaningfully in months — a function of strong earnings, AI-driven sentiment, and a Federal Reserve that has been telegraphing patience on rate cuts. The Feynman explanation: when the Fed is patient, money stays expensive, which makes the present value of future earnings worth less. But the market is pricing stocks as if rate cuts are coming soon — a disconnect that earns a raised eyebrow from anyone who models discounted cash flows seriously. Bond yields are telling a different story than stocks, and historically that conversation ends one of two ways. (Reuters)

Bitcoin Holds Above \$105,000 as Crypto Markets Stabilize Post-Tariff. Bitcoin has found a floor above \$105,000 as crypto markets digest the aftermath of new U.S. tariff announcements that initially spooked digital asset investors. The tariff regime — aimed primarily at semiconductor supply chains and tech hardware — sent crypto on a brief slide before buyers stepped in. The dynamic reflects a broader pattern: crypto is increasingly behaving as a risk-on asset that correlates with tech stocks, not as the safe-haven its advocates once claimed. The Feynman explanation: Bitcoin does not pay a dividend, does not have earnings, and does not represent a claim on any real economy. Its value is entirely a function of what the next person will pay for it — which makes it simultaneously the purest speculation in any portfolio and the most honest expression of market mood. (CoinDesk)

Polymarket Sees Heavy Volume on 2026 Midterm Election Markets. Prediction markets are seeing record volume on congressional control markets ahead of the November midterm elections, with Democrats currently priced at roughly 60 cents on the dollar for taking the House. Polymarket's open interest has surged as institutional traders and political betters alike use the platform to hedge election risk in their portfolios. The Feynman explanation: prediction markets aggregate information more efficiently than polls because they put real money behind beliefs — when someone is willing to bet \$1 million that Democrats win the House, that conveys more information than a million-person poll. Whether that information is actually correct is a different question — but the market is doing what markets do: converting dispersed private information into a single price. (Polymarket)

Goldman Sachs Warns That AI Infrastructure Spending Is Running Ahead of Revenue — Again. Goldman published a note this week flagging that the gap between AI capital expenditures and AI-derived revenue has widened to levels that historically precede either a major productivity breakthrough or a painful correction. The bank is not saying AI is a fraud — it is saying the timeline from

investment to return is longer and less certain than current stock prices imply. Think of it like the early internet buildout: Cisco sold the pipes, the dot-coms built the businesses, and the businesses that survived did so not because they had the best pipes but because they had the best business models. The AI trade is increasingly a pick-and-shovel play — companies selling the infrastructure rather than companies using it. (MarketWatch)

Briefly

- **Federal Reserve Holds Rates Steady.** The Fed kept its benchmark rate unchanged at 5.25-5.50%, with Chair Powell emphasizing that the committee needs more confidence in inflation trending toward 2% before cutting. Markets had priced in a small chance of a cut; the decision sent short-dated Treasury yields slightly higher. (Fed)
 - **Oil Drops on OPEC+ Supply Increase Rumors.** Crude fell roughly 2% on reports that OPEC+ is considering increasing production quotas at its next meeting, reversing a multi-week rally driven by geopolitical supply concerns. Lower oil is a net positive for consumer-facing businesses and a headwind for energy stocks. (Reuters)
 - **Japan's Nikkei Drops from Record Highs.** Japan's benchmark index pulled back from its recent peaks as the yen strengthened against the dollar, weighing on export-oriented Japanese multinationals. The Nikkei is still up more than 15% year-to-date — the sharp pullback from record highs is a reminder that even strong trends take breaks. (Al Jazeera)
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Key Takeaways

- **SpaceX's IPO is the test case for whether private market valuations survive public scrutiny.** At \$250 billion, SpaceX is the biggest company to ever list — and the gap between private secondary pricing and public offering price suggests institutions believe there is more room to run. Watch the first few days of trading closely. If it pops 30%, it validates the private market's thesis. If it sells off, it raises questions about the entire late-stage private tech ecosystem.
- **The AI infrastructure revenue gap is real — but timing is everything.** Goldman is right that AI capex is running ahead of revenue. But that has been true of every major technology platform shift — electricity, the internet, mobile — and the companies that survived the gap period were the ones that kept investing through the noise. The question is not whether the gap exists but whether the companies burning cash on GPUs have the balance sheets and resolve to stay the course.

- Crypto is fully risk-on now. Bitcoin's correlation with tech stocks is now stronger than its correlation with gold. That is a structural change, not a temporary one — and it means crypto traders need to pay attention to what happens with AI stocks, rate expectations, and risk appetite, not just macro tail risk. The ■beep understanding of Bitcoin as "digital gold" needs updating.

Sources: TechCrunch, Reuters, CoinDesk, MarketWatch, Fed, Al Jazeera